



HIGH-IMPACT TEAM DYNAMICS

What makes a great team



THINK OF A TEAM THAT WAS A NIGHTMARE TO WORK IN.

What made it so bad?
Was it skills... or behavior?





The Autopsy

1. What happened in that nightmare team?
2. What did YOU do that made it worse? (Avoidance? Silence? Withdrawal?)



TOPIC 1: NEGATIVE TEAM DYNAMICS

Trust	vs.	FEAR
Clarity	vs.	AMBIGUITY
Accountability	vs.	BLAME
Communication	vs.	SILENCE



Talent ≠ Success

Most teams don't fail because of a lack of talent. They fail because of how people behave under pressure.



THE FOUR KILLERS

Fear (vs. Trust)



Ambiguity (vs. Clarity)



Blame (vs. Accountability)



Blame (vs. Accountability)

Silence (vs. Communication)



The Diagnosis



Action: Rate your current team (1-10) on:

- 1. Trust
- 2. Clarity
- 3. Accountability
- 4. Open Communication



**Where are you
tolerating poor
behavior?**



Why do I need a Complimentary Team?



THE MYTH OF THE PERFECT MANAGER



THE ENGINE OF ACTION (SHORT TERM)



PRODUCER (P)

Focus: Effectiveness

Mandate: Results,
Fast

Question: (What)

Motto: Do it NOW.

ADMINISTRATOR (A)

Focus: Efficiency

Mandate: Systematize,
Order

Question: (How)

Motto: Do it RIGHT.



THE ENGINE OF CHANGE (LONG TERM)



ENTREPRENEUR (E)

Focus: Long-term Effectiveness

Mandate: Vision, Innovation

Question: (Why Not)

Motto: Create the FUTURE

INTEGRATOR (I)

Focus: Long-term Efficiency

Mandate: Organic Unity

Question: (Who)

Motto: Go TOGETHER



PAEI

Source: Dr Ichak Adizes

THE COMPLEMENTARY TEAM



THE CHOICE

Conflict creates energy. Where do we direct it?

DESTRUCTIVE

Differences act as threats.

Result: Infighting,
Stagnation.



CONSTRUCTIVE

Differences act as resources.

Result: Synergy,
Better Decisions.



THE CATALYST: TRUST & RESPECT

RESPECT

Acknowledging the sovereignty of the other.

"I value your opinion because it is different.

You see what I cannot."

TRUST

Faith that we share the same interest.

"I believe you have my back."



In order for conflict to be productive...
mutual respect must be preserved.



ACCEPT YOUR IMPERFECTION, BUILD A TEAM

Stop looking for the perfect leader.
Start building a complementary team based on trust and respect.

Are you looking for people who are similar or different ?

- Look For:
 - Why does this team work?
 - What happens if everyone is the same?



THE TRAP OF DUPLICATION

We often hire for comfort: "I need people who think like me." But if two people on the same team think exactly alike, one of them is unnecessary.





Conflict & Friction



The Leverage

From friction to fuel.



Friction is Necessary

Differences don't break teams. Mismanagement of differences does.

- Action vs. Reflection
- Structure vs. Flexibility
- Task vs. People

Friction Mapping

Identify the person hardest for you to work with.

1. What is THEIR strength?
2. How are you misusing it?
3. How can you leverage it?



THE SILENT EPIDEMIC

“A conversation
I’m not having is...”

- With whom?
- About what?
- Why are you delaying?



**CONFLICT IS NOT THE END
OF THE RELATIONSHIP.
IT IS THE BEGINNING
OF THE REAL ONE.**



THE MINDSET SHIFT:

Avoidance = Decay.

Conflict = Opportunity.

Ingredients: Mutual Trust & Mutual Respect.

THE TWO TIGERS OF MODERN LIFE

**When we sense social danger,
the brain enters FFF Mode:
Fight, Flight, or Freeze.**

Tiger 1: Lack of Control

Cause: Overload, stress, unexplained
change.

Result: Panic / Freeze.

Tiger 2: Lack of Value

Cause: Feeling invisible or alienated.

Result: Withdrawal / Flight.

You cannot have engagement when
the brain is in survival mode.



THE CONVERSATION BLUEPRINT

1. **Join** (Don't flood or dump).
2. **Ask for Feedback** ("What are your thoughts?").
3. **Listen to Learn** (Empathy).
4. **State Purpose & Observations.**





NAVIGATING RESISTANCE

- ‘Hug’ the resistance.
- Reflect back: ‘I understand you are upset...’
- **Slice it thin** (The Salami Principle).
- Breathe and slow down.





Mindset





Mindset





TEAMWORK IS SHAPED BY MINDSET, NOT STRUCTURE.

Most teams don't fail because of lack of talent.
They fail because of how people behave under pressure.
Engagement is not a process; it is an emotional dynamic.

ADAPT OR DIE: THE SHIFT TO PSYCHOLOGICAL SAFETY

Defensive Mindset

Protect self.

Avoid blame.

Hide mistakes.

Productive Mindset

Seek truth.

Take ownership.

Join the conflict.



THE ENGAGEMENT CATALYST: FEELING SEEN

Too often, employees feel invisible. Engagement activates when they feel their contribution is valued.

The Solution (Heinz Kohut):

Mirroring: Managers must mirror positive qualities back to the employee.

Result: A sense of worth and self-esteem that fuels performance.



"A major goal is to give the employee the sensation that their contribution is valued and appreciated."





THE LENS OF GROWTH



FIXED MINDSET

Talent is static. Feedback is an attack.



GROWTH MINDSET

Talent is developed. Feedback is fuel.



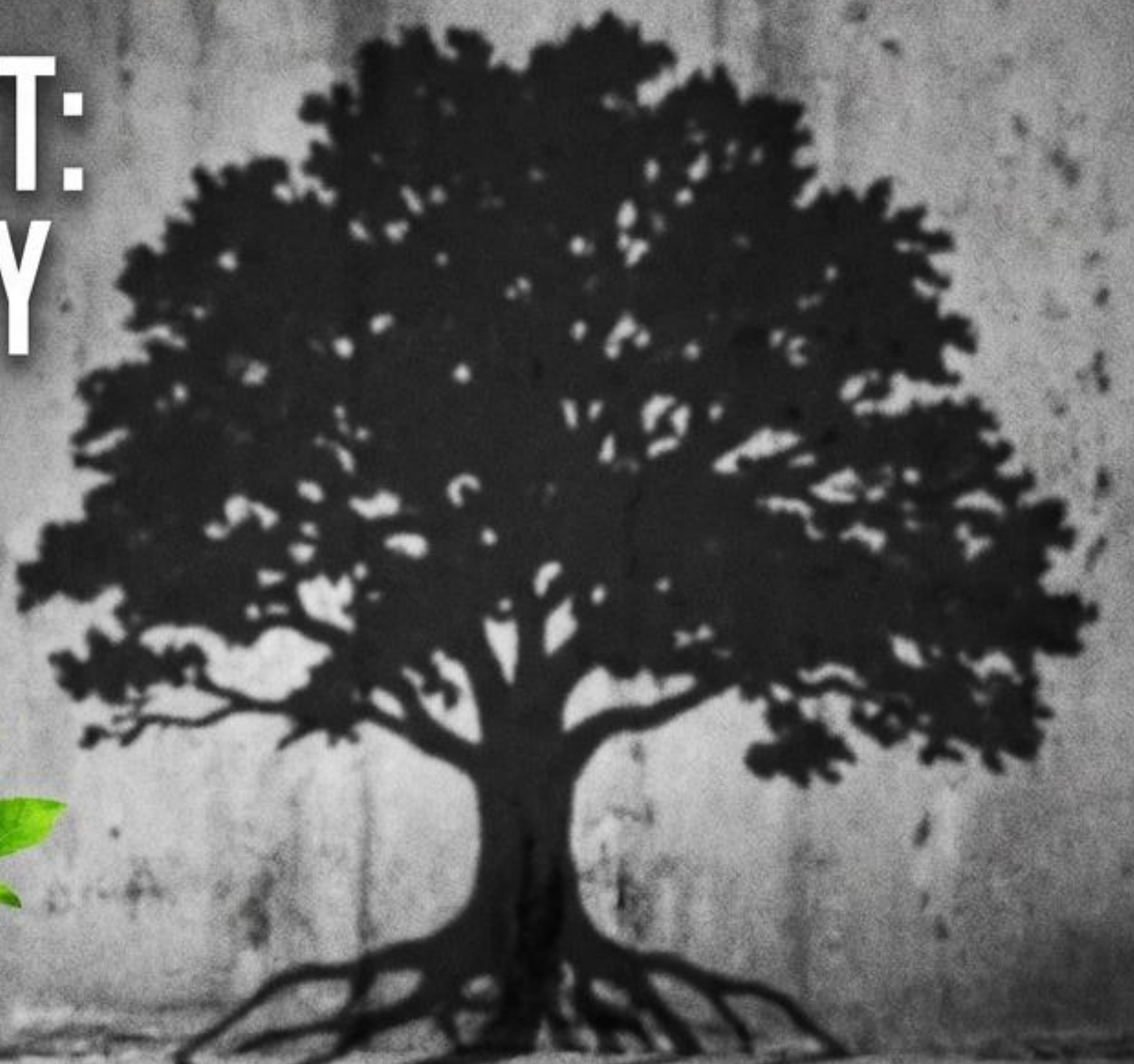
THE PYGMALION EFFECT: BELIEF SHAPES REALITY

If you treat your team as capable,
they become capable.

Fixed Mindset: Capabilities
are static.

Growth Mindset: Capabilities
are developed through effort
and feedback.

Are you projecting belief in their
capabilities, or doubt?



THE PYGMALION EFFECT

“We act according
to how we are treated.”



Manager Expectations → Treatment → Employee Self-Efficacy → Performance



FEELING SEEN

Psychological Safety
in the Future of Work

The Psychological Need (Heinz Kohut)

1. Mirroring positive qualities.
2. Without it, employees feel invisible.
3. Validation fuels performance.



THE INTERVENTION: “THE LETTER”

Reframe your mindset before
you reframe theirs.



THE ASSIGNMENT



1. Write a letter to your employee **BEFORE** the review.
2. List all their great qualities.
3. Articulate exactly why you believe in them.
4. **PRINT IT** and bring it to the meeting.

This is not an easy task, but it is a life-changing one.





Teamwork &
Engagement

The JD-R Equation

Resources Must Exceed Demands to spark Engagement.



DEMANDS

- Complexity
- Emotional Labor
- Workload Pressure
- Result: Energy Drain



RESOURCES

- Team Support
- Autonomy
- Feedback
- Result: Energy Replenishment

The Catalyst: Engaging Leadership

Satisfying basic psychological needs to fuel the engine.



INSPIRING

Connects team to vision.

(Satisfies Need for Meaning)



STRENGTHENING

Delegates responsibility.

(Satisfies Need for Competence)



CONNECTING

Fosters interdependence.

(Satisfies Need for Relatedness)

The Mechanic: Reflexivity

Passive teams survive. Reflexive teams adapt.



Team Learning Behaviors

- ✓ Knowledge Sharing
- ✓ Co-construction of Ideas
- ✓ Constructive Conflict

Reflexivity buffers against Market Turbulence.

The Output: Quantifiable Performance

+77.6%

Increase in Firm Performance linked
to Teamwork Practices.

60.3%

Variance in organizational success
explained by Teamwork.

Teamwork is not a soft skill. It is a statistical driver of ROI.

ENGAGEMENT IS A CHOICE YOU MAKE TOMORROW.

1. Tame the Tigers (Reduce Fear)
2. Stop Avoiding (Seek Truth)
3. Make Them Feel Seen (Mirror Value)

**What is ONE behavior
you will change
tomorrow?**

Most people don't collaborate because they are busy protecting themselves. Choose to join instead.

